

Scratch — Meet the Stage

Grade 2 | Coding | Let's Explore!

■ What is Scratch?

Scratch is a **free coding tool made just for kids!**

You can make **stories, games, and animations** by snapping colourful blocks together.

■ Let's Open Scratch!

1	Open your browser
2	Go to scratch.mit.edu
3	Click ' Create '
4	You're ready to code! ■

■ Meet the Stage!

The Stage is the **white area** where your sprites act, dance, and play!

It's like a **TV screen for your code**.

The Stage is **480 steps wide** and **360 steps tall** — everything you create appears there!

The Stage is also like...

■	A movie screen — sprites are the actors!
■	A canvas — you paint with code!



A playground — sprites run and jump here!

■ Stage Coordinates

The stage uses **X** and **Y** to find positions.

- **X** = left or right (like a number line)
- **Y** = up or down (like a ladder)

The centre of the stage = X: 0, Y: 0

Direction	Axis	Value range
Right →	X +	0 to 240
Left →	X –	0 to –240
Up →	Y +	0 to 180
Down →	Y –	0 to –180

■ Backdrops — Dress the Stage!

A **Backdrop** is the background picture of the Stage.

You can pick from the Scratch library: beach, space, forest, city, and more! It makes your story look real and fun.

How to change a Backdrop:

1	Click the Stage area (bottom right)
2	Click ' Choose a Backdrop '
3	Pick any backdrop you like!
4	Your Stage now has a new look! ■

■ Sprites on the Stage

Sprites are the **characters** on your Stage.

The cat (**Scratch Cat**) is the default sprite.

You can add more sprites: animals, people, objects, letters!

Moving sprites around:

Method	How
Mouse drag	Click and drag any sprite to a new position
Go to x: __ y: __	Teleports the sprite instantly to those coordinates
Glide to x: __ y: __	Smoothly slides the sprite to those coordinates

■ Stage Size & Boundaries

The Stage has **edges** — sprites can't go past them!

- **Width:** 480 steps (-240 to +240)
- **Height:** 360 steps (-180 to +180)

If a sprite hits the edge, it **stops**.

■ Let's Try It! — Activity

Open Scratch and complete these steps:

1	Change the backdrop to ' Beach '
2	Add a new sprite (a fish or crab)
3	Drag the sprite to X: 100, Y: -50
4	Click the Green Flag ■ — what happens?

■ **Tip:** Watch where your sprite appears on the stage. Can you move it to the very centre (X: 0, Y: 0)?

■ Quick Quiz!

Q1	What is the Stage in Scratch? Answer: _____
Q2	What is the centre of the Stage? (X: ____, Y: ____) Answer: _____
Q3	What is a Backdrop? Answer: _____
Q4	Can a sprite go past the edge of the Stage? (Yes / No) Answer: _____

■ Great Job! — Summary

Today we learned:

- ★ ★ The Stage is where everything happens
- ★ ★ It has X and Y coordinates to track positions
- ★ ★ Backdrops make the Stage look cool
- ★ ★ Sprites live and move on the Stage

scratch.mit.edu